Lesson notes · for you

Ask good questions

AI · Level 2 · Lesson 2

Time
25 min

Materials
One homework question you find hard; A notebook and pen; A phone with the Darsi app (for the lab); a chatbot only if your school and family allow it

Learning goals

- Write a clear request: what you want, what you know, your level and the form of the answer.
- Ask for a hint, steps or a quiz instead of the answer.
- Keep personal details out of what you type.

Activity: Prompt makeover

1. Warm-up (3 min): Read Yusuf's one-word request, "fractions". Each person guesses what the chatbot will reply, and why it won't help with his homework.
2. Four parts (5 min): Without looking, list the four parts of a good prompt: what you want, what you already know, your level, and the form of the answer. Check against the Remember slide.
3. Makeover (8 min): Take three weak requests, such as "science help", "write my story" and "fractions". Rewrite each one with all four parts, and turn any "do it for me" into a request for help that keeps you thinking.
4. Hint, not answer (5 min): Each person picks one real homework question and writes a request for a hint for the first step, with their level and what they already know.
5. Privacy check (4 min): Read a sample prompt that includes a name, a school and a phone number. Cross out everything personal, and check that the request still works without it.

For a revision group or at home. Write three weak requests on paper (such as "science help", "write my story" and "fractions") and one sample prompt with a made-up name, school and phone number in it.

Discussion

- Why does "fractions" get a worse answer than a longer request?
- When is asking for the answer fine, and when does it stop you learning?
- What would you never type into a chatbot, and why?

Check yourself

- Write one strong prompt for your next homework that asks for a hint, not the answer.

Try it this week
Take one homework question. If you're allowed to use a chatbot, ask it first for a hint for the first step, and try that step yourself. Then ask for the full answer and compare the two replies: which one taught you something?

Worksheet

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **Which of these should never go into a prompt?**

◯ Your phone number ◯ The topic you're stuck on ◯ The form you want the answer in

◯ The level you're at

2 **Yusuf types one word: "fractions". Which details would make his request better? Choose all that help.**

☐ His full name and school ☐ The form: "step by step, with one example"

☐ His level: "I'm in Grade 7" ☐ His teacher's phone number

☐ What he knows: "I can add with the same denominator"

3 **Match each request to what it asks the AI to do.**

"Give me a hint for the first step."	• • • •	Tests you and shows your gaps
"Explain the method with a new example."	• • • •	A follow-up that improves the last answer
"Quiz me and tell me what I got wrong."	• • • •	Gets you started; you finish it
"Make it shorter, with simpler words."	• • • •	Shows the method; you use it

4 **Complete the sentence.**

A good prompt says what you _____, what you already _____, your _____, and the form of the answer.

Word bank: name · want · password · level · know

5 **If a chatbot's first answer isn't right, it's best to start a new chat and ask again from the beginning.**

◯ True ◯ False

✎ **Think of a subject you find hard. Write one request you could give a chatbot that would help you learn it, not just give you answers.**

Check your answers

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1 **Your phone number**

Your phone number is personal data: the AI doesn't need it to help you, and some tools keep chats.

2 **His level: "I'm in Grade 7"; What he knows: "I can add with the same denominator"; The form: "step by step, with one example"**

His level, what he already knows and the form he wants tell the chatbot exactly what help he needs.

3 **"Give me a hint for the first step." — Gets you started; you finish it**
"Explain the method with a new example." — Shows the method; you use it
"Quiz me and tell me what I got wrong." — Tests you and shows your gaps
"Make it shorter, with simpler words." — A follow-up that improves the last answer

Hints, explanations with new examples and quizzes all leave the thinking to you; a follow-up improves an answer without starting again.

4 **A good prompt says what you <u>want</u>, what you already <u>know</u>, your <u>level</u>, and the form of the answer.**

What you want, what you already know, your level and the form of the answer are the four parts of a good prompt.

5 **False**

Usually it's better to reply with what to change: "shorter", "simpler words", "another example".